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LOW POWER WAKE UP FOR MEMORY

Abstract

Disclosed herein are related to reducing power consumption of a memory device when transitioning from a sleep state to an operational state. In one aspect, the memory device includes a memory cell to store data. In one aspect, the memory device includes an output driver configured to: generate an output signal indicating the stored data, in response to a sleep tracking signal indicating that the memory cell is in the operational state, and generate the output signal having a predetermined voltage irrespective of the stored data, in response to the sleep tracking signal indicating that the memory cell is in the sleep state. In one aspect, the sleep tracking signal is delayed from a sleep control signal causing the memory cell to operate in the sleep state or the operational state.

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Background/Summary

CROSS-REFERENCE TO RELATED APPLICATION [0001] This application is a Continuation Application of U.S. patent application Ser. No. 18/518,157, filed Nov. 22, 2023, which is a Continuation Application of U.S. patent application Ser. No. 17/714,754, filed Apr. 6, 2022, which claims the benefit of and priority to U.S. Provisional Patent Application No. 63/285,883, filed Dec. 3, 2021, each of which is incorporated herein by reference in its entirety.

BACKGROUND

[0002] Developments in electronic devices, such as computers, portable devices, smart phones, internet of thing (IoT) devices, etc., have prompted increased demands for memory devices. In general, memory devices may be volatile memory devices and non-volatile memory devices. Volatile memory devices can store data while power is provided, but may lose the stored data once the power is shut off. Unlike volatile memory devices, non-volatile memory devices may retain data even after the power is shut off, but may be slower than the volatile memory devices.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

[0003] Aspects of the present disclosure are best understood from the following detailed description when read with the accompanying figures. It is noted that, in accordance with the standard practice in the industry, various features are not drawn to scale. In fact, the dimensions of the various features may be arbitrarily increased or reduced for clarity of discussion.

[0004] FIG. 1 illustrates a schematic block diagram of an example memory device, in accordance with some embodiments.

[0005] FIG. 2 illustrates a schematic block diagram of an example memory device including circuitries for performing a wake-up sequence, in accordance with some embodiments.

[0006] FIG. 3 illustrates a schematic diagram of a portion of the memory controller in FIG. 2, in accordance with some embodiments.

[0007] FIG. 4 is a timing diagram showing a wake-up sequence of the memory device, in accordance with some embodiments.

[0008] FIG. 5 illustrates a schematic diagram of a portion of the memory controller in FIG. 2, in accordance with some embodiments.

[0009] FIG. 6 illustrates a schematic diagram of a power detection circuit, in accordance with some embodiments.

[0010] FIG. 7 is a timing diagram showing a wake-up sequence of the memory device, in accordance with some embodiments.

[0011] FIG. 8 illustrates a schematic diagram of a portion of the memory controller in FIG. 2, in accordance with some embodiments.

[0012] FIGS. 9A-9D illustrate schematic diagrams of delay circuits, in accordance with some embodiments.

[0013] FIG. 10 illustrates a schematic diagram of a portion of the memory controller in FIG. 2, in

accordance with some embodiments.

[0014] FIG. 11 is a flowchart showing a method of performing a wake-up sequence by a memory device, in accordance with some embodiments.

[0015] FIG. 12 is an example block diagram of a computing system, in accordance with some embodiments.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION

[0016] The following disclosure provides many different embodiments, or examples, for implementing different features of the provided subject matter. Specific examples of components and arrangements are described below to simplify the present disclosure. These are, of course, merely examples and are not intended to be limiting. For example, the formation of a first feature over, or on a second feature in the description that follows may include embodiments in which the first and second features are formed in direct contact and may also include embodiments in which additional features may be formed between the first and second features, such that the first and second features may not be in direct contact. In addition, the present disclosure may repeat reference numerals and/or letters in the various examples. This repetition is for the purpose of simplicity and clarity and does not in itself dictate a relationship between the various embodiments and/or configurations discussed.

[0017] Further, spatially relative terms, such as “beneath,” “below,” “lower,” “above,” “upper” “top,” “bottom” and the like, may be used herein for ease of description to describe one element or feature's relationship to another element(s) or feature(s) as illustrated in the figures. The spatially relative terms are intended to encompass different orientations of the device in use or operation in addition to the orientation depicted in the figures. The apparatus may be otherwise oriented (rotated 90 degrees or at other orientations) and the spatially relative descriptors used herein may likewise be interpreted accordingly.

[0018] Disclosed herein are related to reducing power consumption of a memory device when transitioning from a sleep state to an operational state. In one aspect, the memory device includes a memory cell to store data. In one aspect, the memory device includes an output driver configured to: generate an output signal indicating the stored data, in response to a sleep tracking signal indicating that the memory cell is in the operational state, and generate the output signal having a predetermined voltage irrespective of the stored data, in response to the sleep tracking signal indicating that the memory cell is in the sleep state. In one aspect, the sleep tracking signal is delayed from a sleep control signal causing the memory cell to enter the sleep state or the operational state.

[0019] Advantageously, the memory device can reduce power consumption when transitioning from the sleep state to the operational state. In one aspect, the controller may generate the sleep control signal causing the memory cell to enter the sleep state or the operational state. In response to the sleep control signal, the memory cell may enter the sleep state or the operational state accordingly. In one aspect, the sleep control signal is propagated through a number of buffer circuits to cause a set of memory cells to enter the sleep state or the operational state. For example, a first buffer circuit can receive the sleep control signal and generate a first delayed control signal to configure a first subset of the set of memory cells in the sleep state or the operational state. Each remaining buffer circuit can receive a delayed control signal from a preceding buffer circuit and generate a corresponding delayed control signal to configure a corresponding subset of the set of memory cells in the sleep state or the operational state. The sleep control signal propagated through the last buffer circuit of the set of buffer circuits may be a sleep tracking signal indicating the status of the set of memory cells indicating whether a transition from the sleep state to the operational state by the set of memory cells is complete. The sleep tracking signal may be delayed with respect to the sleep control signal, due to a capacitive load of the memory cells and/or the number of buffer circuits. In one aspect, causing the output driver to generate the output signal having the predetermined voltage in response to the sleep control signal may cause the output driver to

consume power when the memory cell has not sufficiently transitioned from the sleep state to the operational state. By causing the output driver to generate the output signal having the predetermined voltage in response to the sleep tracking signal, power consumption of the output driver when the memory cell has not sufficiently transitioned from the sleep state to the operational state can be reduced or obviated.

[0020] In one aspect, the memory device includes a delay circuit to delay the sleep tracking signal. The memory device may further include a wake-up detection circuit coupled to the delay circuit. The wake-up detection circuit may generate a wake-up complete signal indicating whether a transition from the sleep state to the operational state by the memory cell is complete, based on the delayed sleep tracking signal. For example, the wake-up complete signal may have a high voltage (e.g., 1V) to indicate that the transition from the sleep state to the operational state by the memory cell is incomplete, in response to the delayed sleep tracking signal having a high voltage (e.g., 1V) indicating that the memory cell is in a sleep state. For example, the wake-up complete signal may have a low voltage (e.g., 0V) to indicate that the transition from the sleep state to the operational state by the memory cell is complete, in response to the delayed sleep tracking signal having a low voltage (e.g., 0V) or logic value '0' indicating that the memory cell is in the operational state.

[0021] In one aspect, the memory device includes a power detection circuit configured to detect an internal supply voltage provided to one or more circuits in the output driver, and to generate a power detection signal indicating whether the internal supply voltage has reached a threshold voltage. The wake-up detection circuit may generate the wake-up complete signal, further based on the power detection signal. For example, the wake-up complete signal may have a high voltage (e.g., 1V) to indicate that the transition from the sleep state to the operational state by the memory cell is incomplete, in response to the power detection signal having a high voltage (e.g., 1V) indicating that the internal supply voltage has not reached a threshold voltage. For example, the wake-up complete signal may have a low voltage (e.g., 0V) to indicate that the transition from the sleep state to the operational state by the memory cell is complete, in response to the power detection signal having a low voltage (e.g., 0V) indicating that the internal supply voltage has reached the threshold voltage.

[0022] Advantageously, the wake-up detection circuit may generate the wake up complete signal accurately, when the memory cell and the output driver have transitioned from the sleep state to the operational state. In one aspect, the internal supply voltage provided to the one or more circuits of the output driver may change, in response to the sleep control signal. For example, the internal supply voltage may be set to a first voltage (e.g., 0V) when the output driver is in the sleep state, and may be set to a second voltage (e.g., 1V) when the output driver is in the operational state. Due to capacitive loading, the change in the internal supply voltage may be delayed with respect to the change in the sleep control signal. By causing the wake-up detection circuit to generate the wake-up complete signal based on the delayed sleep tracking signal and/or the power detection signal, the wake up complete signal can be generated accurately when the internal supply voltage has reached a sufficient voltage for the output driver to be operational. Accordingly, prematurely causing other operations such as reading data stored by the memory cell before the memory cell and the output driver have sufficiently transitioned from the sleep state to the operational state can be obviated, such that the memory device can operate in a reliable manner with reduced power consumption.

[0023] In some embodiments, one or more components can be embodied as one or more transistors. The transistors in this disclosure are shown to have a certain type (N-type or P-type), but embodiments are not limited thereto. The transistors can be any suitable type of transistors including, but not limited to, metal oxide semiconductor field effect transistors (MOSFETs), bipolar junction transistors (BJTs), high voltage transistors, high frequency transistors, FinFETs, planar MOS transistors with raised source/drains, nanosheet FETs, nanowire FETs, or the like. Furthermore, one or more transistors shown or described herein can be embodied as two or more transistors connected in parallel.

[0024] FIG. 1 is a diagram of a memory device **100**, in accordance with one embodiment. In some embodiments, the memory device **100** includes a memory controller **105** and a memory array **120**. The memory array **120** may include a plurality of storage circuits or memory cells **125** arranged in two or three dimensional arrays. Each memory cell **125** may be coupled to a corresponding word line WL and a corresponding bit line BL. The memory controller **105** may write data to or read data from the memory array **120** according to electrical signals through word lines WL and bit lines BL. In other embodiments, the memory device **100** includes more, fewer, or different components than shown in FIG. 1.

[0025] The memory array **120** is a hardware component that stores data. In one aspect, the memory array **120** is embodied as a semiconductor memory device. The memory array **120** includes a plurality of storage circuits or memory cells **125**. The memory array **120** includes word lines WL**0**, WL**1** WLJ, each extending in a first direction (e.g., X-direction) and bit lines BL**0**, BL**1** BLK, each extending in a second direction (e.g., Y-direction). The word lines WL and the bit lines BL may be conductive metals or conductive rails. In one aspect, each memory cell **125** is coupled to a corresponding word line WL and a corresponding bit line BL, and can be operated according to voltages or currents through the corresponding word line WL and the corresponding bit line BL. In some embodiments, each bit line includes bit lines BL, BLB coupled to one or more memory cells **125** of a group of memory cells **125** disposed along the second direction (e.g., Y-direction). The bit lines BL, BLB may receive and/or provide differential signals. Each memory cell **125** may include a volatile memory, a non-volatile memory, or a combination of them. In some embodiments, each memory cell **125** is embodied as a static random access memory (SRAM) cell or other type of memory cell. In some embodiments, the memory array **120** includes additional lines (e.g., select lines, reference lines, reference control lines, power rails, etc.).

[0026] The memory controller **105** is a hardware component that controls operations of the memory array **120**. In some embodiments, the memory controller **105** includes a bit line controller **112**, a word line controller **114**, and a main controller **110**. The bit line controller **112**, the word line controller **114**, and the main controller **110** may be embodied as logic circuits, analog circuits, or a combination of them. In one configuration, the word line controller **114** is a circuit that provides a voltage or current through one or more word lines WL of the memory array **120**, and the bit line controller **112** is a circuit that provides or senses a voltage or current through one or more bit lines BL of the memory array **120**. In one configuration, the main controller **110** is a circuit that provides control signals or clock signals to synchronize operations of the bit line controller **112** and the word line controller **114**. In some embodiments, the main controller **110** is embodied as or include a processor and a non-transitory computer readable medium storing instructions when executed by the processor cause the processor to execute one or more functions of the main controller **110** or the memory controller **105** described herein. The bit line controller **112** may be coupled to bit lines BL of the memory array **120**, and the word line controller **114** may be coupled to word lines WL of the memory array **120**. In some embodiments, the memory controller **105** includes more, fewer, or different components than shown in FIG. 1.

[0027] In one example, the main controller **110** may generate control signals to coordinate operations of the bit line controller **112** and the word line controller **114**. For example, the main controller **110** may generate one or more enable signals to enable or disable operations of the bit line controller **112** and/or the word line controller **114**. In one approach, to write data to a memory cell **125**, the main controller **110** may cause the word line controller **114** to apply a voltage or current to the memory cell **125** through a word line WL coupled to the memory cell **125** and cause the bit line controller **112** to apply a voltage or current corresponding to data to be stored to the memory cell **125** through a bit line BL coupled to the memory cell **125**. In one approach, to read data from a memory cell **125**, the main controller **110** may cause the word line controller **114** to apply a voltage or current to the memory cell **125** through a word line WL coupled to the memory cell **125** and cause the bit line controller **112** to sense a voltage or current corresponding to data

stored by the memory cell **125** through a bit line BL coupled to the memory cell **125**.

[0028] In some embodiments, the main controller **110** includes a sleep control circuit **175** and a wake-up detection circuit **185**. Through these components, the main controller **110** may perform a wake up sequence and report a status of the memory device **100**.

[0029] The sleep control circuit **175** is a circuit that generates a sleep control signal to cause the memory cells **125** and one or more components (e.g., bit line controller **112** and the word line controller **114**) of the memory controller **105** to enter a sleep state (also referred to as “a power management state”) or an operational state. For example, the sleep control signal having a first voltage (e.g., 0V) may cause the one or more components (e.g., bit line controller **112** and the word line controller **114**) of the memory controller **105** to enter the operational state. For example, the sleep control signal having a second voltage (e.g., 1V) may cause one or more components (e.g., bit line controller **112** and the word line controller **114**) of the memory controller **105** to enter the sleep state. In the sleep state, the memory cells **125** and the one or more components of the memory controller **105** may be powered off or may consume lower power than in the operational state. In the operational state, the memory cells **125** and the one or more components of the memory controller **105** may be fully operational to support reading data or writing data and may consume more power than in the sleep state.

[0030] The wake-up detection circuit **185** is a circuit that generates a wake-up complete signal indicating whether the wake up sequence is complete. In one aspect, the wake-up detection circuit **185** may receive a sleep tracking signal. The sleep tracking signal may be a signal tracking a status of the group of memory cells **125**. For example, the sleep tracking signal may indicate whether the group of memory cells **125** is in the sleep state or in the operational state. Based on the sleep tracking signal, the wake-up detection circuit **185** may determine whether a wake-up sequence is complete or not, and generate the wake-up complete signal, accordingly. According to the wake-up complete signal, the memory device **100** may perform various operations. For example, in response to the wake-up complete signal indicating that the memory cells **125** have not completed the wake-up sequence, the memory device **100** may not perform a read or write operation. For example, in response to the wake-up complete signal indicating that the memory cells **125** have completed the wake-up sequence, the memory device **100** may perform a read or write operation. Detailed description on implementation and operation of the wake-up detection circuit **185** is provided below with respect to FIGS. 2-11.

[0031] FIG. 2 illustrates a schematic block diagram of an example memory device **100** including circuitries for performing a wake-up sequence, in accordance with some embodiments. In some embodiments, the memory device **100** includes the memory controller **105** disposed below the memory array **120**.

[0032] In some embodiments, the memory array **120** may be divided into regions, and each region can be configured separately or independently. In one example, the memory array **120** may be divided into a top region and a bottom region. The memory array **120** may include an interface circuit **215A** that receives a top control signal TOP and a clock signal ICLK from the memory controller **105** and operates the memory cells **125** in the top region of the memory array **120** according to the top control signal TOP and the clock signal ICLK. The memory array **120** may include an interface circuit **215B** that receives a bottom control signal BOT and the clock signal ICLK from the memory controller **105** and operates the memory cells **125** in the bottom region of the memory array **120** according to the bottom control signal BOT and the clock signal ICLK.

[0033] In one aspect, the interface circuits **215A**, **215B** receive a sleep control signal SLP or a delayed signal of the sleep control signal SLP from the memory controller **105** and cause the memory cells **125** to change the state according to the sleep control signal SLP. The sleep control signal may be a signal causing the memory cells **125** to enter the sleep state or the operational state. For example, the memory array **120** includes buffer circuits **245A** . . . **245C** that propagate a sleep control signal SLP. The buffer circuits **245A** . . . **245C** may be connected in cascade to propagate

the sleep control signal SLP. Each buffer circuit **245** may delay a sleep control signal or a delayed sleep control signal, such that a corresponding region of memory cells can be individually or separately controlled. Rather than simultaneously configuring a state of a large set of memory cells, configuring a state of subsets or regions of memory cells according to delayed control signals can help prevent a large amount of current through the set of memory cells in a short time period to protect the memory cells. In one configuration, the interface circuit **215B** receives the sleep control signal SLP and causes memory cells **125** in a left portion **205A** of the bottom region to enter the sleep state or the operational state according to the sleep control signal SLP. The buffer circuit **245A** may delay the sleep control signal SLP to obtain a first delayed signal **208A**. The interface circuit **215B** may receive the first delayed signal **208A**, and cause memory cells **125** in a right portion **205B** of the bottom region to enter the sleep state or the operational state according to the first delayed signal **208A**. The buffer circuit **245B** may delay the first delayed signal **208A** to obtain a second delayed signal **208B**. The interface circuit **215A** may receive the second delayed signal **208B**, and cause memory cells **125** in a left portion **205C** of the top region to enter the sleep state or the operational state according to the second delayed signal **208B**. The buffer circuit **245C** may delay the second delayed signal **208B** to obtain a sleep tracking signal SLP_TRK. The interface circuit **215A** may receive the sleep tracking signal SLP_TRK, and cause memory cells **125** in a right portion **205D** of the top region to enter the sleep state or the operational state according to the sleep tracking signal SLP_TRK. In one aspect, the sleep tracking signal SLP_TRK is a last delayed signal of the sleep control signal SLP propagated through the buffer circuits **245A** . . . **245C**. Although three buffer circuits **245A** . . . **245C** are shown in FIG. 2, the memory device **100** may include a different number of buffer circuits **245**.

[0034] In some embodiments, the memory controller **105** includes the sleep control circuit **175**, the wake-up detection circuits **185A**, **185B**, a decoder **230**, output drivers **280A**, **280B**, and delay circuits **290A**, **290B**, **295A**, **295B**, **292**. These components may operate together to configure the status of the memory array **120**, and generate a signal reporting the status of the memory array **120**. In some embodiments, the memory controller **105** includes more, fewer, or different components than shown in FIG. 2.

[0035] In some embodiments, the decoder **230** is a component that receives a clock signal CLK, an enable signal CEB, and an address signal ADR [N:0], for example, from a host device or a processing device, and generates the clock signal ICLK, the top control signal TOP, and the bottom control signal BOT, accordingly. In some embodiments, the decoder **230** can be replaced by a different component that can perform the functionalities of the decoder **230** disclosed herein. For example, the decoder **230** may generate the clock signal ICLK having pulses of the clock signal CLK, in response to the enable signal CEB enabling the clock signal ICLK to be provided to the top region or the bottom region. The decoder **230** may select the top region or the bottom region, according to the address signal ADR [N:0] and generate the top control signal TOP or the bottom control signal BOT, accordingly. For example, in response to the address signal ADR [N:0] indicating a top region of the memory cells, the decoder **230** may generate the top control signal TOP to enable providing the clock signal ICLK to the top region of the memory cells. For example, in response to the address signal ADR [N:0] indicating a bottom region of the memory cells, the decoder **230** may generate the bottom control signal BOT to enable providing the clock signal ICLK to the bottom region of the memory cells.

[0036] In some embodiments, the sleep control circuit **175** receives a signal DSLP and a signal SD, and generates the sleep control signal SLP according to the signal DSLP and the signal SD. The signals DSLP, SD may be signals to configure the memory device **100** in the sleep state or the operational state. The signal DSLP may be provided from a first device (e.g., processor or external host device), where the signal SD may be provided from a second device (e.g., control device or internal device). The sleep control circuit **175** may be embodied as an OR gate. The sleep control circuit **175** may perform an OR operation on the signal DSLP and the signal SD to generate the

sleep control signal SLP. For example, the sleep control circuit **175** may generate the sleep control signal SLP having a high voltage (e.g., 1V), in response to either one of the signal DSLP or the signal SD having a high voltage (e.g., 1V). For example, the sleep control circuit **175** may generate the sleep control signal SLP having a low voltage (e.g., 0V), in response to both the signal DSLP and the signal SD having a low voltage (e.g., 0V). In some embodiments, the sleep control circuit **175** can be replaced by a different component that can perform the functionalities of the sleep control circuit **175** disclosed herein.

[0037] In some embodiments, the delay circuits **290A**, **290B**, **292** are circuits to delay the sleep tracking signal SLP_TRK. Each of the delay circuits **290A**, **290B**, **292** may include an even number of inverter circuits, one or more amplifier circuits, one or more buffer circuits, one or more resistive delay circuits, adjustable delay circuits, or any delay circuits. The delay circuit **290A** may delay the sleep tracking signal SLP_TRK to obtain a delayed signal SLPQ_TRK_LEFT and provide the delayed signal SLPQ_TRK_LEFT to the output drivers **280A**. The delay circuit **290A** may operate as a buffer between the buffer circuit **245C** and the output drivers **280A** to reduce a capacitive load at the output of the buffer circuit **245C**. Similarly, the delay circuit **290B** may delay the sleep tracking signal SLP_TRK to obtain a delayed signal SLPQ_TRK_RIGHT and provide the delayed signal SLPQ_TRK_RIGHT to the output drivers **280B**. The delay circuit **290B** may operate as a buffer between the buffer circuit **245C** and the output drivers **280B** to reduce a capacitive load at the output of the buffer circuit **245C**. In some embodiments, the delay circuit **292** receives the delayed signal SLPQ_TRK_RIGHT and delay the signal SLPQ_TRK_RIGHT to obtain a delayed signal SLPQ_TRKR. The delay circuit **292** may provide the delayed signal SLPQ_TRKR to the wake-up detection circuits **185A**, **185B**. In some embodiments, the delay circuit **292** may receive the delayed signal SLPQ_TRK_LEFT instead of the delayed signal SLPQ_TRK_RIGHT and delay the delayed signal SLPQ_TRK_LEFT to obtain the delayed signal SLPQ_TRKR.

[0038] In some embodiments, the delay circuits **295A**, **295B** are circuits to delay the sleep control signal SLP. The delay circuit **295A** may delay the sleep control signal SLP to obtain a delayed signal SLPQ_LEFT and provide the delayed signal SLPQ_LEFT to the output drivers **280A**. The delay circuit **295A** may operate as a buffer between the sleep control circuit **175** and the output drivers **280A** to reduce a capacitive load at the output of the sleep control circuit **175**. Similarly, the delay circuit **295B** may delay the sleep control signal SLP to obtain a delayed signal SLPQ_RIGHT and provide the delayed signal SLPQ_RIGHT to the output drivers **280B**. The delay circuit **295B** may operate as a buffer between the sleep control circuit **175** and the output drivers **280B** to reduce a capacitive load at the output of the sleep control circuit **175**.

[0039] In some embodiments, the output drivers **280A**, **280B** are circuits to provide data stored by a set of memory cells **125**. In one aspect, the output drivers **280A** are coupled to one or more sense amplifiers that amplify signals corresponding to data stored by memory cells **125** in a left region. In one aspect, the output drivers **280B** are coupled to one or more sense amplifiers that amplify signals corresponding to data stored by memory cells **125** in a right region. The output drivers **280A** may receive the delayed signal SLPQ_TRK_LEFT, the delayed signal SLPQ_LEFT, and amplified signals from sense amplifiers corresponding to memory cells **125** in the left region and generate output data signals Q1 Qn corresponding to data stored by the memory cells **125** in the left region, accordingly. For example, in response to the delayed signal SLPQ_TRK_LEFT indicating that the memory cells **125** are in the sleep state or the delayed signal SLPQ_LEFT causing the output drivers **280A** to be configured in the sleep state, the output drivers **280A** may generate the output data signals Q1 Qn having a predetermined voltage (e.g., 0V corresponding to a bit '0'). For example, in response to the delayed signal SLPQ_TRK_LEFT indicating that the memory cells **125** are in the operational state and the delayed signal SLPQ_LEFT causing the output drivers **280A** to be configured in the operational state, the output drivers **280A** may generate the output data signals Q1 Qn indicating the stored data, according

to the amplified signals from the sense amplifiers. The output drivers **280B** may operate in a similar manner as the output drivers **280A** with respect to the delayed signal SLPQ_TRK_RIGHT, the delayed signal SLPQ_RIGHT, and amplified signals from sense amplifiers corresponding to memory cells **125** in the right region and generate output data signals $Q_{n+1} \dots Q_m$ corresponding to data stored by the memory cells **125** in the right region, accordingly. Detailed description on configuration and operation of the output drivers **280A**, **280B** is provided below with respect to FIGS. **3** and **4**.

[0040] In some embodiments, the wake-up detection circuits **185A**, **185B** are circuits that generate wake up complete signals WAKEUP_DONE_SD, WAKEUP_DONE_DSLP (also referred to as “WAKEUP_DONE”). A wake-up complete signal WAKEUP_DONE may indicate whether the wake up sequence is complete or not. In one aspect, the wake-up detection circuits **185A**, **185B** receive the delayed signal SLPQ_TRK_RIGHT or the delayed signal SLPQ_TRK_LEFT, and generate the wake up complete signals WAKEUP_DONE, accordingly. For example, in response to the delayed signal SLPQ_TRK_RIGHT or the delayed signal SLPQ_TRK_LEFT indicating that the memory cells **125** are operating in the sleep state, the wake-up detection circuits **185A**, **185B** may generate the wake-up complete signals WAKEUP_DONE having a first voltage (e.g., 1V) to indicate that the wake up sequence is incomplete. For example, in response to the delayed signal SLPQ_TRK_RIGHT or the delayed signal SLPQ_TRK_LEFT indicating that the memory cells **125** are operating in the operational state, the wake-up detection circuits **185A**, **185B** may generate the wake up complete signals WAKEUP_DONE having a second voltage (e.g., 0V) to indicate that the wake up sequence is complete. Detailed description on configuration and operation of wake-up detection circuits **185A**, **185B** is provided below with respect to FIGS. **3-8**, **10** and **11**.

[0041] FIG. **3** illustrates a schematic diagram of a portion **298A** of the memory controller **105** in FIG. **2**, in accordance with some embodiments. In one aspect, the portion **298A** of the memory controller **105** includes the output drivers **280B1** . . . **280BM**, the delay circuits **290B**, **292**, **295** (e.g., **295B**), and the wake-up detection circuits **185A**, **185B**. In some embodiments, the delay circuit **290B** receives the sleep tracking signal SLP_TRK and generates a delayed signal SLPQ_TRK_RIGHT. The output drivers **280B1** . . . **280BM** may receive the delayed signal SLPQ_TRK_RIGHT and generate output data signals $Q_{n+1} \dots Q_m$, according to the delayed signal SLPQ_TRK_RIGHT. The delay circuit **292** may receive the delayed signal SLPQ_TRK_RIGHT after the delayed signal SLPQ_TRK_RIGHT is provided to the output driver **280BM** and delay the delayed signal SLPQ_TRK_RIGHT to obtain another delayed signal SLPQ_TRKR. The delay circuit **292** may provide the delayed sleep tracking signal SLPQ_TRKR to a delay circuit **330**. The delay circuit **292** may operate as a buffer or an amplifier to amplify the delayed signal SLPQ_TRK_RIGHT provided to the output buffers **280B1** . . . **280BM**. The delay circuit **330** may receive the delayed signal SLPQ_TRKR and delay the delayed signal SLPQ_TRKR to obtain a delayed signal **335**. The delay circuit **330** may operate as a buffer or an amplifier to amplify the delayed sleep tracking signal SLPQ_TRKR provided from the delay circuit **292** through a long metal rail extending along the output buffers **280B1** . . . **280BM**. The delay circuit **330** may include an even number of inverter circuits, one or more amplifier circuits, one or more buffer circuits, one or more resistive delay circuits, an adjustable delay circuits, or any delay circuits. The delay circuit **330** may provide the delayed signal **335** to the wake-up detection circuits **185A**, **185B**.

[0042] In some embodiments, the wake-up detection circuit **185A** includes or is implemented as an OR gate. The wake-up detection circuit **185A** may receive the delayed signal **335** and a signal DSLP, and perform an OR operation on the delayed signal **335** and the signal DSLP to generate the wake up complete signal WAKEUP_DONE_DSLP according to the OR operation.

[0043] In some embodiments, the wake-up detection circuit **185B** includes or is implemented as an OR gate. The wake-up detection circuit **185B** may receive the delayed signal **335** and a signal SD and perform OR operation on the delayed signal **335** and the signal SD to generate the wake up

complete signal WAKEUP_DONE_SD according to the OR operation.

[0044] In one aspect, each output driver **280** includes a latch circuit **350**, a power switch SW, and an output circuit **380**. These components may operate together to selectively provide an output data Q, according to the delayed sleep control signal SLPQ_RIGHT, the delayed sleep tracking signal SLPQ_TRK_RIGHT, or both. For example, in response to the delayed signal SLPQ_TRK_RIGHT indicating that the memory cell **125** is in the sleep state or the delayed signal SLPQ_RIGHT causing the latch circuit **350** to be configured in the sleep state, the output drivers **280** may generate the output data signal Q having a predetermined voltage (e.g., 0V corresponding to a bit '0'). For example, in response to the delayed signal SLPQ_TRK_RIGHT indicating that the memory cell **125** is in the operational state and the delayed signal SLPQ_RIGHT causing the latch circuit **350** to be configured in the operational state, the output drivers **280** may generate the output data signal Q indicating the stored data, according to the amplified signal from a sense amplifier coupled to the memory cell **125**.

[0045] In one configuration, the power switch SW is embodied as a P-type transistor. In some embodiments, the power switch SW can be replaced by a different component that can perform the functionalities of the power switch SW disclosed herein. The power switch SW may include a source electrode coupled to a power rail to receive a supply voltage VDD, a gate electrode coupled to an output of a delay circuit **295**, and a drain electrode coupled to a latch circuit **350**. In this configuration, the power switch SW may receive the delayed sleep control signal SLPQ_RIGHT and selectively provide an internal supply voltage VDDI corresponding to the supply voltage VDD to the latch circuit **350**, according to the delayed sleep control signal SLPQ_RIGHT. For example, the power switch SW can be enabled, in response to the delayed sleep control signal SLPQ_RIGHT having a low voltage (e.g., 0V) to provide the supply voltage VDD to the internal supply voltage VDDI of the latch circuit **350**. For example, the power switch SW can be disabled, in response to the delayed sleep control signal SLPQ_RIGHT having a high voltage (e.g., 1V) to not provide the supply voltage VDD to the internal supply voltage VDDI of the latch circuit **350**.

[0046] The latch circuit **350** receives an amplified signal corresponding to the stored data of a memory cell from a sense amplifier and stores the amplified signal. In some embodiments, the latch circuit **350** can be replaced by a different component that can perform the functionalities of the latch circuit **350** disclosed herein. In one configuration, the latch circuit **350** includes an input coupled to an output of a sense amplifier and an output coupled to a first input of the output circuit **380**. In this configuration, when the internal supply voltage VDDI has a sufficient voltage (e.g., larger than 0.7~0.9V), the latch circuit **350** may be enabled, and receive and store the amplified signal QB from the sense amplifier. When the internal supply voltage VDDI does not have the sufficient voltage, the latch circuit **350** may be disabled or may not be operational, and may not store the amplified signal QB from the sense amplifier.

[0047] The output circuit **380** is a component that generates the output data Q, according to the stored amplified signal QB from the sense amplifier and the delayed sleep tracking signal SLPQ_TRK_RIGHT. In some embodiments, the output circuit **380** is embodied as a NOR circuit. In some embodiments, the output circuit **380** can be replaced by a different component that can perform the functionalities of the output circuit **380** disclosed herein. In one configuration, the output circuit **380** includes a first input coupled to an output of the latch circuit **350**, and a second input coupled to an output of the delay circuit **290B**. In this configuration, the output circuit **380** may receive the stored amplified signal QB at the first input and the delayed sleep tracking signal SLPQ_TRK_RIGHT at the second input, and perform an OR operation on the stored amplified signal QB and the delayed sleep tracking signal SLPQ_TRK_RIGHT to generate the output data Q.

[0048] In some embodiments, the delay circuit **295** receives the sleep control signal SLP and generates the control signal SLPQ_RIGHT according to the sleep control signal SLP. According to the control signal SLPQ_RIGHT, the output drivers **280B1 . . . 280BM** may be enabled or disabled. In one configuration, the memory controller **105** includes a power switch SWO coupled to an

output of the delay circuit **295**. In one configuration, the power switch SWO is embodied as a P-type transistor. The power switch SWO may be the same type of transistor as the power switches SWs in the output drivers **280**. In some embodiments, the power switch SWO can be replaced by a different component that can perform the functionalities of the power switch SWO disclosed herein. The power switch SWO may include a source electrode coupled to a power rail to receive a supply voltage VDD, a gate electrode coupled to the output of a delay circuit **295**, and a drain electrode coupled to a power detection circuit (not shown). In this configuration, the drain electrode of the power switch SWO may have the internal supply voltage VDDI, which can be provided to the power detection circuit to determine the internal supply voltage VDDI provided to the output drivers **280**.

[0049] Advantageously, the memory device **100** can reduce power consumption when transitioning from the sleep state to the operational state. In one aspect, causing the output circuit **380** to generate the output signal Q having the predetermined voltage (e.g., 0V) in response to the sleep control signal SLP or the control signal SLPQ_RIGHT may cause the output driver **280** to consume power when the memory cell **125** has not sufficiently transitioned from the sleep state to the operational state. By causing the output circuit **380** to generate the output signal Q having the predetermined voltage in response to the sleep tracking signal SLP_TRK or the delayed sleep tracking signal SLPQ_TRK_RIGHT, power consumption of the output driver **280** when the memory cell **125** has not sufficiently transitioned from the sleep state to the operational state can be reduced or obviated.

[0050] Advantageously, the wake-up detection circuit **185** may generate the wake up complete signal WAKEUP_DONE (e.g., WAKEUP_DONE_SD or WAKEUP_DONE_DSLP) accurately, when the memory cell **125** and the output driver **280** have transitioned from the sleep state to the operational state. In one aspect, the internal supply voltage VDDI provided to the one or more circuits of the output driver **280** may change, in response to the sleep control signal SLP. For example, the internal supply voltage VDDI may be set to a first voltage (e.g., 0V) when the sleep control signal SLP having a second voltage (e.g., 1V) causes the output driver **280** to be in the sleep state. The internal supply voltage VDDI may be set to the second voltage (e.g., 1V) when the sleep control signal SLP having the first voltage (e.g., 0V) causes the output driver **280** to be in the operational state. Due to capacitive loading, the change in the internal supply voltage VDDI may be delayed with respect to the change in the sleep control signal SLP or the control signal SLPQ_RIGHT. By causing the wake-up detection circuit **185** to generate the wake-up complete signal WAKEUP_DONE based on the delayed signal **335**, the wake up complete signal WAKEUP_DONE can be generated accurately when the internal supply voltage VDDI has reached a sufficient voltage for the output driver **280** to be operational. Accordingly, prematurely causing other operations such as reading data stored by the memory cell **125** before the memory cell **125** and the output driver **280** have transitioned from the sleep state to the operational state can be obviated, such that the memory device **100** can operate in a reliable manner with reduced power consumption.

[0051] FIG. **4** is a timing diagram **400** showing a wake-up sequence of the memory device **100**, in accordance with some embodiments. In one aspect, the memory device **100** operates in an operational state during a time period TO, then enters a sleep state during a time period T1. Then, the memory device **100** enters a transition state (or a wake-up state) during a time period T2, and enters the operational state during the time period T3.

[0052] In the time period TO, the sleep control circuit **175** generates the sleep control signal SLP having a low voltage (e.g., 0V) causing the memory cells **125** to operate in the operational state. In the time period TO, the sleep control signal SLP is propagated through the buffer circuits **245A** . . . **245C**, where each buffer circuit **245** can generate a delayed control signal to configure a corresponding region of memory cells. In the time period TO, the buffer circuit **245C** (or last buffer circuit) generates the sleep tracking signal SLP_TRK having the low voltage (e.g., 0V) to indicate

that the memory cells **125** are in the operational state.

[0053] In the time period **T0**, the delay circuit **290B** receives the sleep tracking signal **SLP_TRK**, and generates the delayed sleep tracking signal **SLPQ_TRK** (or **SLPQ_TRK_RIGHT**) having the low voltage (e.g., 0V), in response to the sleep tracking signal **SLP_TRK** having the low voltage. The delay circuit **290B** may provide the delayed sleep tracking signal **SLPQ_TRK** (or **SLPQ_TRK_RIGHT**) to the output circuits **380**. The delay circuit **292** may receive the delayed sleep tracking signal **SLPQ_TRK** (or **SLPQ_TRK_RIGHT**), and generate the delayed sleep tracking signal **SLPQ_TRKR** having the low voltage (e.g., 0V) to indicate that the memory cells **125** and the output drivers **280** are in the operational state, in response to the delayed sleep tracking signal **SLPQ_TRK** (or **SLPQ_TRK_RIGHT**) having the low voltage. In the time period **T0**, in response to delayed sleep tracking signal **SLPQ_TRKR** having the low voltage (e.g., 0V), the wake up detection circuit **185** may generate the wake up complete signal **WAKEUP_DONE** having the low voltage (e.g., 0V) to indicate that the memory device **100** is operating in the operational state.

[0054] In the time period **T0**, the delay circuit **295B** (or **295**) receives the sleep control signal **SLP**, and generates the control signal **SLPQ_RIGHT** following or delayed from the sleep control signal **SLP** having the low voltage (e.g., 0V). In the time period **T0**, in response to the control signal **SLPQ_RIGHT** having the low voltage (e.g., 0V), the latch circuits **350** may be powered on, and may provide the stored amplified signals **QB** to the output circuits **380**. In the time period **T0**, the output circuits **380** may generate the output signals **Q** indicating the data stored by the memory cells **125** according to the stored amplified signals **QB**, in response to the delayed sleep tracking signal **SLPQ_TRK_RIGHT** (or **SLPQ_TRK**) having the low voltage (e.g., 0V). For example, in the time period **T0**, the output circuits **380** may generate the output signals **Q** indicating the data stored by the memory cells **125** as an inverse of (or an opposite value of) the stored amplified signals **QB**, in response to the delayed sleep tracking signal **SLPQ_TRK_RIGHT** (or **SLPQ_TRK**) having the low voltage (e.g., 0V).

[0055] In the time period **T1**, the sleep control circuit **175** generates the sleep control signal **SLP** having a high voltage (e.g., 1V) causing the memory cells **125** to operate in the sleep state. In the time period **T0**, the sleep control signal **SLP** is propagated through the buffer circuits **245A . . . 245C**. In the time period **T1**, after a certain delay due to the buffer circuits **245A . . . 245C**, the buffer circuit **245C** (or last buffer circuit) generates the sleep tracking signal **SLP_TRK** having the high voltage (e.g., 1V) to indicate that the memory cells **125** are in the sleep state.

[0056] In the time period **T1**, the delay circuit **290B** receives the sleep tracking signal **SLP_TRK**, and generates the delayed sleep tracking signal **SLPQ_TRK** (or **SLPQ_TRK_RIGHT**) having the high voltage (e.g., 1V), in response to the sleep tracking signal **SLP_TRK** having the high voltage. The delay circuit **290B** may provide the delayed sleep tracking signal **SLPQ_TRK** (or **SLPQ_TRK_RIGHT**) to the output circuits **380**. The delay circuit **292** may receive the delayed sleep tracking signal **SLPQ_TRK** (or **SLPQ_TRK_RIGHT**), and generate the delayed sleep tracking signal **SLPQ_TRKR** having the high voltage (e.g., 1V) to indicate that the memory cells **125** and the output drivers **280** are in the sleep state, in response to the delayed sleep tracking signal **SLPQ_TRK** (or **SLPQ_TRK_RIGHT**) having the high voltage. In the time period **T1**, in response to the delayed sleep tracking signal **SLPQ_TRKR** having the high voltage (e.g., 1V), the wake-up detection circuit **185** may generate the wake up complete signal **WAKEUP_DONE** having the high voltage (e.g., 1V) to indicate that the memory device **100** is operating in the sleep state or the wake up sequence has not completed yet.

[0057] In the time period **T1**, the delay circuit **295B** (or **295**) receives the sleep control signal **SLP**, and generates the control signal **SLPQ_RIGHT** following or delayed from the sleep control signal **SLP** having the high voltage (e.g., 1V). In the time period **T1**, the latch circuits **350** may be powered off, in response to the control signal **SLPQ_RIGHT** having the high voltage (e.g., 1V). In addition, in the time period **T1**, the output circuits **380** may generate the output signal **Q** having a predetermined voltage (e.g., 0V) irrespective of data stored by the memory cells **125**, in response to

the delayed sleep tracking signal SLPQ_TRK_RIGHT (or SLPQ_TRK) having the high voltage (e.g., 1V).

[0058] In the time period T2, the sleep control circuit 175 generates the sleep control signal SLP having a low voltage (e.g., 0V) to initiate a wake-up sequence. The sleep control signal SLP transitioning from the high voltage (e.g., 1V) to a low voltage (e.g., 0V) may cause the memory cells 125 to transition from the sleep state to the operational state. In the time period T2, the sleep control signal SLP is propagated through the buffer circuits 245A . . . 245C, where each buffer circuit 245 can generate a delayed control signal to configure a corresponding region of memory cells. The sleep tracking signal SLP_TRK may be delayed with respect to the sleep control signal SLP, because of the delay associated with the buffer circuits 245A . . . 245C. In the time period T2, the buffer circuit 245C (or last buffer circuit) generates the sleep tracking signal SLP_TRK having the low voltage (e.g., 0V) after a certain delay (e.g., delay associated with the buffer circuits 245A . . . 245C) from the sleep control signal SLP transitioning to the low voltage (e.g., 0V).

[0059] In the time period T2, the delay circuit 290B receives the sleep tracking signal SLP_TRK, and generates the delayed sleep tracking signal SLPQ_TRK (or SLPQ_TRK_RIGHT), according to the sleep tracking signal SLP_TRK. In the time period T2, the delayed sleep tracking signal SLPQ_TRK (or SLPQ_TRK_RIGHT) may still have the high voltage (e.g., 1V), due to delay associated with the delay circuit 290B. In the time period T2, the delay circuit 290B may provide the delayed sleep tracking signal SLPQ_TRK (or SLPQ_TRK_RIGHT) to the output circuits 380. In the time period T2, the delay circuit 292 may receive the delayed sleep tracking signal SLPQ_TRK (or SLPQ_TRK_RIGHT), and generate the delayed sleep tracking signal SLPQ_TRKR following or delayed from the sleep tracking signal SLP_TRK or the delayed sleep tracking signal SLPQ_TRK (or SLPQ_TRK_RIGHT) having the high voltage (e.g., 1V) to indicate that the wake up sequence has not completed yet. In the time period T2, the delayed sleep tracking signal SLPQ_TRKR may still have the high voltage (e.g., 1V), due to delay associated with the delay circuit 292. In the time period T2, in response to the delayed sleep tracking signal SLPQ_TRKR having the high voltage (e.g., 1V), the wake-up detection circuit 185 may generate the wake up complete signal WAKEUP_DONE having the high voltage (e.g., 1V) to indicate that the memory device 100 is still operating in the sleep state or the wake up sequence has not completed yet.

[0060] In the time period T2, the delay circuit 295B (or 295) receives the sleep control signal SLP, and generates the control signal SLPQ_RIGHT following or delayed from the sleep control signal SLP having the low voltage (e.g., 0V) after a certain delay (e.g., delay associated with the delay circuit 295). In the time period T2, in response to the control signal SLPQ_RIGHT having the low voltage (e.g., 0V), the latch circuits 350 may be powered on. In the time period T2, the latch circuits 350 may receive amplified signals corresponding to data stored by the memory cells 125 and store the amplified signals QB. However, in the time period T2, the output circuits 380 may maintain the output signal Q having the predetermined voltage (e.g., 0V) irrespective of data stored by the memory cells 125, in response to the delayed sleep tracking signal SLPQ_TRK_RIGHT (or SLPQ_TRK) having the high voltage (e.g., 1V).

[0061] In the time period T3, the sleep control signal SLP has the low voltage (e.g., 0V). In the time period T3, the sleep tracking signal SLP_TRK may have the low voltage (e.g., 0V). In the time period T3, the control signal SLPQ_RIGHT may also have the low voltage (e.g., 0V). In the time period T3, the delayed sleep tracking signal SLPQ_TRK_RIGHT (or SLPQ_TRK) following or delayed from the sleep tracking signal SLP_TRK may have the low voltage (e.g., 0V). In the time period T3, the latch circuits 350 may be still powered on, in response to the control signal SLPQ_RIGHT having the low voltage (e.g., 0V), and may provide the stored amplified signals QB to the output circuits 380. In the time period T3, the output circuits 380 may generate the output signal Q indicating the data stored by the memory cells 125 according to the stored amplified signals QB, in response to the delayed sleep tracking signal SLPQ_TRK_RIGHT (or SLPQ_TRK)

having the low voltage (e.g., 0V). In the time period T3, in response to the delayed sleep tracking signal SLPQ_TRK_RIGHT (or SLPQ_TRK) having the low voltage (e.g., 0V), the delay circuit **292** may generate the delayed sleep tracking signal SLPQ_TRKR having the low voltage (e.g., 0V). For example, in the time period T3, the output circuits **380** may generate the output signals Q indicating the data stored by the memory cells **125** as an inverse of (or an opposite value of) the stored amplified signals QB, in response to the delayed sleep tracking signal SLPQ_TRK_RIGHT (or SLPQ_TRK) having the low voltage (e.g., 0V). In the time period T3, in response to the delayed sleep tracking signal SLPQ_TRKR having the low voltage (e.g., 0V), the wake-up detection circuit **185** may generate the wake up complete signal WAKEUP_DONE having the low voltage (e.g., 0V) to indicate that the memory device **100** is operating in the operational state or the wake up sequence has completed.

[0062] Advantageously, the memory device **100** can reduce power consumption in the wake-up state or when transitioning from the sleep state to the operational state. In one aspect, causing the output circuit **380** to generate the output signal Q having the predetermined voltage (e.g., 0V) in response to the sleep control signal SLP or the control signal SLPQ_RIGHT may cause the output driver **280** to consume power when the memory cell **125** has not sufficiently transitioned from the sleep state to the operational state. By causing the output circuit **380** to generate the output signal Q having the predetermined voltage in response to the sleep tracking signal SLP_TRK or the delayed sleep tracking signal SLPQ_TRK_RIGHT, power consumption of the output driver **280** when the memory cell **125** has not sufficiently transitioned from the sleep state to the operational state can be reduced or obviated.

[0063] FIG. 5 illustrates a schematic diagram of a portion **298B** of the memory controller **105** in FIG. 2, in accordance with some embodiments. In one aspect, the portion **298B** of the memory controller **105** is similar to the portion **298A** of the memory controller **105** in FIG. 3, except the memory controller **105** includes a power detection circuit **520** coupled to the drain electrode of the power switch SWO, and the wake-up detection circuits **185A**, **185B**. Thus, detailed description on duplicated portion thereof is omitted herein for the sake of brevity.

[0064] In some embodiments, the power detection circuit **520** includes an input coupled to the drain electrode of the power transistor SWO, and an output coupled to inputs of the wake-up detection circuits **185A**, **185B**. In this configuration, the power detection circuit **520** may receive the internal supply voltage VDDI from the power transistor SWO and generate a power detection signal VDDI_RDYB according to the internal supply voltage VDDI. For example, if the internal supply voltage VDDI is higher than a threshold voltage (e.g., 0.7~0.9V), the power detection circuit **520** may generate the power detection signal VDDI_RDYB having a low voltage (e.g., 0V) to indicate that the output drivers **280** have sufficient power or internal supply voltage VDDI to be operational. For example, if the internal supply voltage VDDI is less than the threshold voltage (e.g., 0.7~0.9V), the power detection circuit **520** may generate the power detection signal VDDI_RDYB having a high voltage (e.g., 1V) to indicate that the output drivers **280** do not have sufficient power or internal supply voltage VDDI to be operational.

[0065] The wake-up detection circuits **185A**, **185B** may generate the wake-up complete signals WAKEUP_DONE_SD, WAKEUP_DONE_DSLP, further based on the power detection signal VDDI_RDYB. For example, the wake-up detection circuit **185A** may be implemented as a three input OR gate, and perform an OR operation on an input signal DSLP, the power detection signal VDDI_RDYB, and the delayed signal **335** to generate the wake-up complete signals WAKEUP_DONE_DSLP according to the OR operation. Similarly, for example, the wake-up detection circuit **185B** may be implemented as a three input OR gate, and perform an OR operation on an input signal SD, the power detection signal VDDI_RDYB, and the delayed signal **335** to generate the wake up complete signals WAKEUP_DONE_SD according to the OR operation.

[0066] Advantageously, the wake-up detection circuit **185** may generate the wake up complete signal WAKEUP_DONE accurately, when the memory cell **125** and the output driver **280** have

transitioned from the sleep state to the operational state. In one aspect, the internal supply voltage VDDI provided to the one or more circuits of the output driver **280** may change, in response to the sleep control signal SLP. For example, the internal supply voltage VDDI may be set to a first voltage (e.g., 0V) when the sleep control signal SLP has a high voltage (e.g., 1V) causing the output driver **280** to be in the sleep state. The internal supply voltage VDDI may be set to a second voltage (e.g., 1V) when the sleep control signal SLP has a low voltage (e.g., 0V) causing the output driver **280** to be in the operational state. Due to capacitive loading, the change in the internal supply voltage VDDI may be delayed with respect to the change in the sleep control signal SLP or the control signal SLPQ_RIGHT. By causing the wake-up detection circuit **185** to generate the wake up complete signal WAKEUP_DONE based on the delayed signal **335** and the power detection signal VDDI_RDYB, the wake up complete signal WAKEUP_DONE can be generated accurately when the internal supply voltage VDDI has reached a sufficient voltage for the output driver **280** to be operational. Accordingly, prematurely causing other operations such as reading data stored by the memory cell **125** before the memory cell **125** and the output driver **280** have sufficiently transitioned from the sleep state to the operational state can be obviated, such that the memory device **100** can operate in a reliable manner with reduced power consumption.

[0067] FIG. **6** illustrates a schematic diagram of the power detection circuit **520**, in accordance with some embodiments. In some embodiments, the power detection circuit **520** includes transistors M1 . . . M6. The transistors M1 . . . M3 are embodied as P-type transistors, and the transistors M4 . . . M6 are embodied as N-type transistors. These components may operate together to detect an internal supply voltage VDDI and generate the power detection signal VDDI_RDYB according to the internal supply voltage VDDI. For example, if the internal supply voltage VDDI is higher than a threshold voltage (e.g., 0.7~0.9V), the power detection circuit **520** may generate the power detection signal VDDI_RDYB having a low voltage (e.g., 0V) to indicate that the output drivers **280** have sufficient power or internal supply voltage VDDI to be operational. For example, if the internal supply voltage VDDI is less than the threshold voltage (e.g., 0.7~0.9V), the power detection circuit **520** may generate the power detection signal VDDI_RDYB having a high voltage (e.g., 1V) to indicate that the output drivers **280** do not have sufficient power or internal supply voltage VDDI to be operational. In some embodiments, the power detection circuit **520** includes more, fewer, or different components than shown in FIG. **6**.

[0068] In one configuration, the transistor M1 includes a source electrode coupled to a power rail to receive a supply voltage VDD, and a gate electrode coupled to an input of the power detection circuit **520**. In one configuration, a drain electrode of the transistor M1 is coupled to a source electrode of the transistor M2 and a source electrode of the transistor M3. In one configuration, the transistor M2 includes a gate electrode coupled to the input of the power detection circuit **520**, and a drain electrode coupled to an output of the power detection circuit **520**. In one configuration, the transistor M3 includes a gate electrode coupled to the output of the power detection circuit **520**, and a drain electrode coupled to a ground rail to receive a ground voltage VSS.

[0069] In one configuration, the transistor M4 includes a source electrode coupled to the ground rail to receive the ground voltage VSS, and a gate electrode coupled to the input of the power detection circuit **520**. In one configuration, a drain electrode of the transistor M4 is coupled to a source electrode of the transistor M5 and a source electrode of the transistor M6. In one configuration, the transistor M5 includes a gate electrode coupled to the input of the power detection circuit **520**, and a drain electrode coupled to the output of the power detection circuit **520**. In one configuration, the transistor M6 includes a gate electrode coupled to the output of the power detection circuit **520**, and a drain electrode coupled to the power rail to receive the supply voltage VDD.

[0070] In this configuration, the transistors M1 . . . M6 may be arranged as a Schmitt trigger, and generate the power detection signal VDDI_RDYB according to the internal supply voltage VDDI. For example, if the internal supply voltage VDDI is higher than a threshold voltage (e.g.,

0.7~0.9V), the transistors M4, M5 may be enabled and the transistors M1, M2 may be disabled to pull down a voltage at the output of the power detection circuit 520. By pulling down the voltage at the output of the power detection circuit 520, the power detection signal VDDI_RDYB at the output of the power detection circuit 520 may have a low voltage (e.g., 0V) to indicate that the output drivers 280 have sufficient power or internal supply voltage VDDI to be operational. For example, if the internal supply voltage VDDI is less than the threshold voltage (e.g., 0.7~0.9V), the transistors M4, M5 may be disabled and the transistors M1, M2 may be enabled to pull up the voltage at the output of the power detection circuit 520. By pulling up the voltage at the output of the power detection circuit 520, the power detection signal VDDI_RDYB at the output of the power detection circuit 520 may have a high voltage (e.g., 1V) to indicate that the output drivers 280 do not have sufficient power or internal supply voltage VDDI to be operational.

[0071] FIG. 7 is a timing diagram 700 showing a wake-up sequence of the memory device 100, in accordance with some embodiments. In one aspect, the signals SLP, SLPQ_RIGHT, WAKE DONE, and SLPQ_TRKR are similar to the ones as described in FIG. 4. Thus, detailed description of duplicated portion thereof is omitted herein for the sake of brevity.

[0072] In the time period TO, the delay circuit 295 generates the delayed signal SLPQ_RIGHT having a low voltage (e.g., 0V), in response to the sleep control signal SLP having a low voltage (e.g., 0V). In response to the delayed signal SLPQ_RIGHT having the low voltage, the power switch SW can be enabled. By enabling the power switch SW, the internal supply voltage VDDI may have a high voltage (e.g., 1V) to enable the latch circuit 350 of the output driver 280. In the time period TO, the power detection circuit 520 may detect that the supply voltage VDDI is higher than the threshold voltage and generate the power detection signal VDDI_RDYB having a low voltage (e.g., 0V) to indicate that the output drivers 280 have sufficient power or internal supply voltage VDDI to be operational. In the time period TO, in response to the delayed sleep tracking signal SLPQ_TRKR (or SLPQ_TRK_RIGHT) having the low voltage (e.g., 0V) and the power detection signal VDDI_RDYB having the low voltage (e.g., 0V), the wake-up detection circuit 185 may generate the wake up complete signal WAKEUP_DONE having the low voltage (e.g., 0V) to indicate that the memory device 100 is operating in the operational state.

[0073] In the time period T1, the delay circuit 295 generates the delayed signal SLPQ_RIGHT having a high voltage (e.g., 1V), in response to the sleep control signal SLP having a high voltage (e.g., 1V). In response to the SLPQ_RIGHT having the high voltage (e.g., 1V), the power switch SW can be disabled. By disabling the power switch SW, the internal supply voltage VDDI may decrease towards a low voltage (e.g., 0V) to disable the latch circuit 350 of the output driver 280. Because of capacitive loads of the output drivers 280, the internal supply voltage VDDI may not change or drop immediately. In the time period T1, the power detection circuit 520 may detect that the supply voltage VDDI is still higher than the threshold voltage and generate or maintain the power detection signal VDDI_RDYB having the low voltage (e.g., 0V) to indicate that the output drivers 280 have sufficient power or internal supply voltage VDDI to be operational. In the time period T1, in response to the delayed sleep tracking signal SLPQ_TRKR (or SLPQ_TRK_RIGHT) having the high voltage (e.g., 1V), the wake-up detection circuit 185 may generate the wake up complete signal WAKEUP_DONE having the high voltage (e.g., 1V) to indicate that the memory device 100 is operating in the sleep state.

[0074] In the time period T2, the sleep control signal SLP has a low voltage (e.g., 0V) to initiate a wake-up sequence. The sleep control signal SLP having the low voltage (e.g., 0V) may cause the memory cells 125 to operate in the operational state. In the time period T2, the delay circuit 295 generates the delayed signal SLPQ_RIGHT having a low voltage (e.g., 0V) after a certain delay (e.g., delay associated with the delay circuit 295) from the sleep control signal transitioning to the low voltage (e.g., 0V). In the time period T2, the power switch SW is enabled, when the SLPQ_RIGHT has a low voltage (e.g., 0V). By enabling the power switch SW, the internal supply voltage VDDI may increase towards a high voltage (e.g., 1V) to enable the latch circuit 350 of the

output driver **280**. However, because of capacitive loads of the output drivers **280**, the internal supply voltage VDDI may not change immediately. Hence, the power detection circuit **520** may maintain the power detection signal VDDI_RDYB having the high voltage (e.g., 1V), because the internal supply voltage VDDI may be still lower than the threshold voltage. In the time period T2, the delayed sleep tracking signal SLPQ_TRKR (or SLPQ_TRK_RIGHT) following or delayed from the sleep tracking signal SLP_TRK may be transitioned from the high voltage (e.g., 1V) to the low voltage (e.g., 0V) after a certain delay (e.g., delay associated with the delay circuits **290B**, **292**). In the time period T2, in response to i) the delayed sleep tracking signal SLPQ_TRKR (or SLPQ_TRK_RIGHT) having the high voltage (e.g., 1V) during a first portion of the time period T2 before transitioning to the low voltage (e.g., 0V) and ii) the power detection signal VDDI_RDYB having the high voltage (e.g., 1V) during a second portion of the time period T2, the wake up detection circuit **185** may generate or maintain the wake up complete signal WAKEUP_DONE having the high voltage (e.g., 1V) to indicate that the memory device **100** is still operating in the sleep state or the wake up sequence has not completed yet.

[0075] In the time period T3, the power detection circuit **520** may detect that the supply voltage VDDI is larger than the threshold voltage and generate the power detection signal VDDI_RDYB having the low voltage (e.g., 0V) to indicate that the output drivers **280** have sufficient power or internal supply voltage VDDI to be operational. In the time period T3, in response to the delayed sleep tracking signal SLPQ_TRKR (or SLPQ_TRK_RIGHT) having the low voltage (e.g., 0V) and the power detection signal VDDI_RDYB having the low voltage (e.g., 0V), the wake up detection circuit **185** may generate the wake up complete signal WAKEUP_DONE having the low voltage (e.g., 0V) to indicate that the wake up sequence has completed and the memory device **100** is operating in the operational state.

[0076] Advantageously, the wake-up detection circuit **185** may generate the wake up complete signal WAKEUP_DONE accurately, when the memory cell **125** and the output driver **280** have transitioned from the sleep state to the operational state. In one aspect, the internal supply voltage VDDI provided to the one or more circuits of the output driver **280** may change, in response to the sleep control signal SLP. For example, the internal supply voltage VDDI may be set to a first voltage (e.g., 0V) when the sleep control signal SLP has a second voltage (e.g., 1V) causing the output driver **280** to be in the sleep state, and may be set to the second voltage (e.g., 1V) when the sleep control signal SLP has the first voltage (e.g., 0V) causing the output driver **280** to be in the operational state. Due to capacitive loading, the change in the internal supply voltage VDDI may be delayed with respect to the change in the sleep control signal SLP or the control signal SLPQ_RIGHT. By causing the wake-up detection circuit **185** to generate the wake up complete signal WAKEUP_DONE based on the delayed signal **335** and the power detection signal VDDI_RDYB, the wake up complete signal WAKEUP_DONE can be generated accurately when the internal supply voltage VDDI has reached a sufficient voltage for the output driver **280** to be operational. Accordingly, prematurely causing other operations such as reading data stored by the memory cell **125** before the memory cell **125** and the output driver **280** have sufficiently transitioned from the sleep state to the operational state can be obviated, such that the memory device **100** can operate in a reliable manner with reduced power consumption.

[0077] FIG. 8 illustrates a schematic diagram of a portion **298C** of the memory controller **105** in FIG. 2, in accordance with some embodiments. In one aspect, the portion **298C** of the memory controller **105** is similar to the portion **298A** of the memory controller **105** in FIG. 3, except the memory controller **105** includes delay circuits **830**, **840**, **890** to replace the delay circuits **330**, **292**, **290B**, respectively. Thus, detailed description of duplicated portion thereof is omitted herein for the sake of brevity. Each of the delay circuits **830**, **840**, **890** can be embodied as shown in FIGS. 9A-9D.

[0078] FIGS. 9A-9D illustrate schematic diagrams of delay circuits **900A** . . . **900D**, in accordance with some embodiments. Each of the delay circuits **900A** . . . **900D** can be implemented as one or

more delay circuit disclosed herein. In some embodiments, the memory device **100** may implement a different delay circuit than shown in FIGS. **9A-9D**. In some embodiments, the delay circuit **900A** in FIG. **9A** includes a first delay circuit **910** similar to the power detection circuit **520** or a Schmitt trigger shown in FIG. **6**, and a second delay circuit **920** embodied as an inverter circuit. In some embodiments, the delay circuit **900B** in FIG. **9B** includes a first delay circuit **930** embodied as an inverter circuit, and the second delay circuit **920** embodied as an inverter circuit. In some embodiments, the delay circuit **900C** in FIG. **9C** includes the first delay circuit **910**, the second delay circuit **920**, and a resistive component **925** (e.g., metal rail or high resistive material) between the first delay circuit **910** and the second delay circuit **920**. In one aspect, the resistive component **925** can be selected or adjusted to obtain a target delay. In some embodiments, the delay circuit **900D** in FIG. **9D** includes an even number of inverters **950** connected in cascade. In one aspect, a number of inverters **950** can be selected or adjusted to obtain a target delay.

[0079] FIG. **10** illustrates a schematic diagram of the portion **298D** of the memory controller **105** in FIG. **2**, in accordance with some embodiments. In one aspect, the portion **298D** of the memory controller **105** is similar to the portion **298B** of the memory controller **105** in FIG. **3**, except the memory controller **105** includes a delay circuit **1010** between the power detection circuit **520** and the wake-up detection circuits **185**. Thus, detailed description of duplicated portion thereof is omitted herein for the sake of brevity. The delay circuit **1010** can be embodied as shown in FIGS. **9A-9D**. In some embodiments, the delay circuit **1010** can be implemented as a variable delay circuit. By delaying the output of the power detection circuit **520**, prematurely generating the wake-up complete signals WAKEUP_DONE (e.g., WAKEUP_DONE_SD, WAKEUP_DONE_DSLP) before the memory cells **125** and the output drivers **280** have sufficiently transitioned to the operational state can be obviated.

[0080] FIG. **11** is a flowchart showing a method **1100** of performing a wake-up sequence by a memory device, in accordance with some embodiments. In some embodiments, the method **1100** is performed by a controller (e.g., memory controller **105** or main controller **110**). In some embodiments, the method **1100** is performed by other entities. In some embodiments, the method **1100** includes more, fewer, or different steps than shown in FIG. **11**.

[0081] In one approach, the controller generates **1110** a sleep control signal (e.g., sleep control signal SLP) to cause a memory cell (e.g., memory cell **125**) to transition from a sleep state to an operational state to initiate a wake-up sequence. For example, the memory array **120** includes buffer circuits **245A . . . 245C** that propagate a sleep control signal SLP. The buffer circuits **245A . . . 245C** may be connected in cascade to propagate the sleep control signal SLP for different memory cells **125**.

[0082] In one approach, the controller generates **1120** an output signal (e.g., output signal Q) to have a predetermined voltage (e.g., 0V), irrespective of the data stored by the memory cell **125**, in response to a sleep tracking signal indicating that the memory cell has not transitioned to the operational state yet. In one approach, an output driver (e.g., output circuit **380**) of the controller receives a sleep tracking signal (e.g., SLP_TRK). A sleep tracking signal may be delayed from the sleep control signal SLP. For example, the sleep tracking signal may be a last delayed signal from last buffer circuit of the buffer circuits **245A . . . 245C**. Hence, the sleep tracking signal may indicate that the last memory cell of a set of memory cells has transitioned from the sleep state to the operational state. Until the sleep tracking signal indicating that the memory cell has transitioned to the operational state, the output driver (e.g., output circuit **380**) of the controller may generate and maintain the output signal to have the predetermined state.

[0083] In one approach, the controller detects **1130** the memory cell has transitioned from the sleep state to the operational state. In one approach, after a certain delay from the sleep control signal, the sleep tracking signal may indicate that the memory cell has complete a wake-up sequence and transitioned from the sleep state to the operational state.

[0084] In one approach, the controller generates **1140** the output signal to indicate the data stored

by the memory cell after the memory cell has transitioned from the sleep state to the operational state. For example, in response to the sleep tracking signal indicating that the memory cell has transitioned to the operational state, the output driver (e.g., output circuit **380**) of the controller may receive a signal indicative of data stored by the memory cell, for example, from a sense amplifier or a latch (e.g., **350**) coupled to the sense amplifier, and generate the output signal indicating the data.

[0085] Advantageously, the memory device can reduce power consumption when transitioning from the sleep state to the operational state. In one aspect, causing the output driver to generate the output signal having the predetermined voltage in response to the sleep control signal may cause the output driver to consume power when the memory cell has not sufficiently transitioned from the sleep state to the operational state. By causing the output driver to generate the output signal having the predetermined voltage in response to the sleep tracking signal, power consumption of the output driver when the memory cell has not sufficiently transitioned from the sleep state to the operational state can be reduced or obviated.

[0086] Referring now to FIG. **12**, an example block diagram of a computing system **1200** is shown, in accordance with some embodiments of the disclosure. The computing system **1200** may be used by a circuit or layout designer for integrated circuit design. A “circuit” as used herein is an interconnection of electrical components such as resistors, transistors, switches, batteries, inductors, or other types of semiconductor devices configured for implementing a desired functionality. The computing system **1200** includes a host device **1205** associated with a memory device **1210**. The host device **1205** may be configured to receive input from one or more input devices **1215** and provide output to one or more output devices **1220**. The host device **1205** may be configured to communicate with the memory device **1210**, the input devices **1215**, and the output devices **1220** via appropriate interfaces **1225A**, **1225B**, and **1225C**, respectively. The computing system **1200** may be implemented in a variety of computing devices such as computers (e.g., desktop, laptop, servers, data centers, etc.), tablets, personal digital assistants, mobile devices, other handheld or portable devices, or any other computing unit suitable for performing schematic design and/or layout design using the host device **1205**.

[0087] The input devices **1215** may include any of a variety of input technologies such as a keyboard, stylus, touch screen, mouse, track ball, keypad, microphone, voice recognition, motion recognition, remote controllers, input ports, one or more buttons, dials, joysticks, and any other input peripheral that is associated with the host device **1205** and that allows an external source, such as a user (e.g., a circuit or layout designer), to enter information (e.g., data) into the host device and send instructions to the host device. Similarly, the output devices **1220** may include a variety of output technologies such as external memories, printers, speakers, displays, microphones, light emitting diodes, headphones, video devices, and any other output peripherals that are configured to receive information (e.g., data) from the host device **1205**. The “data” that is either input into the host device **1205** and/or output from the host device may include any of a variety of textual data, circuit data, signal data, semiconductor device data, graphical data, combinations thereof, or other types of analog and/or digital data that is suitable for processing using the computing system **1200**.

[0088] The host device **1205** includes or is associated with one or more processing units/processors, such as Central Processing Unit (“CPU”) cores **1230A . . . 1230N**. The CPU cores **1230A . . . 1230N** may be implemented as an Application Specific Integrated Circuit (“ASIC”), Field Programmable Gate Array (“FPGA”), or any other type of processing unit. Each of the CPU cores **1230A . . . 1230N** may be configured to execute instructions for running one or more applications of the host device **1205**. In some embodiments, the instructions and data to run the one or more applications may be stored within the memory device **1210**. The host device **1205** may also be configured to store the results of running the one or more applications within the memory device **1210**. Thus, the host device **1205** may be configured to request the memory device **1210** to

perform a variety of operations. For example, the host device **1205** may request the memory device **1210** to read data, write data, update or delete data, and/or perform management or other operations. One such application that the host device **1205** may be configured to run may be a standard cell application **1235**. The standard cell application **1235** may be part of a computer aided design or electronic design automation software suite that may be used by a user of the host device **1205** to use, create, or modify a standard cell of a circuit. In some embodiments, the instructions to execute or run the standard cell application **1235** may be stored within the memory device **1210**. The standard cell application **1235** may be executed by one or more of the CPU cores **1230A** . . . **1230N** using the instructions associated with the standard cell application from the memory device **1210**. In one example, the standard cell application **1235** allows a user to utilize pre-generated schematic and/or layout designs of the memory device **100** or a portion of the memory device **100** to aid integrated circuit design. After the layout design of the integrated circuit is complete, multiples of the integrated circuit, for example, including the memory device **100**, or any portion of the memory device **100** can be fabricated according to the layout design by a fabrication facility.

[0089] Referring still to FIG. **12**, the memory device **1210** includes a memory controller **1240** that is configured to read data from or write data to a memory array **1245**. The memory array **1245** may include a variety of volatile and/or non-volatile memories. For example, in some embodiments, the memory array **1245** may include NAND flash memory cores. In other embodiments, the memory array **1245** may include NOR flash memory cores, Static Random Access Memory (SRAM) cores, Dynamic Random Access Memory (DRAM) cores, Magnetoresistive Random Access Memory (MRAM) cores, Phase Change Memory (PCM) cores, Resistive Random Access Memory (ReRAM) cores, 3D XPoint memory cores, ferroelectric random-access memory (FeRAM) cores, and other types of memory cores that are suitable for use within the memory array. The memories within the memory array **1245** may be individually and independently controlled by the memory controller **1240**. In other words, the memory controller **1240** may be configured to communicate with each memory within the memory array **1245** individually and independently. By communicating with the memory array **1245**, the memory controller **1240** may be configured to read data from or write data to the memory array in response to instructions received from the host device **1205**. Although shown as being part of the memory device **1210**, in some embodiments, the memory controller **1240** may be part of the host device **1205** or part of another component of the computing system **1200** and associated with the memory device **1210**. The memory controller **1240** may be implemented as a logic circuit in either software, hardware, firmware, or combination thereof to perform the functions described herein. For example, in some embodiments, the memory controller **1240** may be configured to retrieve the instructions associated with the standard cell application **1235** stored in the memory array **1245** of the memory device **1210** upon receiving a request from the host device **1205**.

[0090] It is to be understood that only some components of the computing system **1200** are shown and described in FIG. **12**. However, the computing system **1200** may include other components such as various batteries and power sources, networking interfaces, routers, switches, external memory systems, controllers, etc. Generally speaking, the computing system **1200** may include any of a variety of hardware, software, and/or firmware components that are needed or considered desirable in performing the functions described herein. Similarly, the host device **1205**, the input devices **1215**, the output devices **1220**, and the memory device **1210** including the memory controller **1240** and the memory array **1245** may include other hardware, software, and/or firmware components that are considered necessary or desirable in performing the functions described herein.

[0091] In one aspect of the present disclosure, a memory device is disclosed. In some embodiments, the memory device includes a memory cell to store data. In some embodiments, the memory device includes an output driver coupled to the memory cell. In some embodiments, the output driver is configured to: generate an output signal indicating the stored data, in response to a

sleep tracking signal indicating that the memory cell is in an operational state and generate the output signal having a predetermined voltage irrespective of the stored data, in response to the sleep tracking signal indicating that the memory cell is in a sleep state. In some embodiments, the sleep tracking signal is delayed from a sleep control signal causing the memory cell to operate in the sleep state or the operational state.

[0092] In another aspect of the present disclosure, a memory device is disclosed. In some embodiments, the memory device includes a memory cell to store data. In some embodiments, the memory device includes a delay circuit configured to receive a sleep tracking signal indicating whether the memory cell is in a sleep state or in an operational state and delay the sleep tracking signal to obtain a delayed sleep tracking signal. In some embodiments, the memory device includes a wake-up detection circuit coupled to the delay circuit. In some embodiments, the wake-up detection circuit is configured to generate a wake up complete signal indicating whether a transition from the sleep state to the operational state by the memory cell is complete, based on the delayed sleep tracking signal.

[0093] In yet another aspect of the present disclosure, a method of operating a memory device is disclosed. In some embodiments, the method includes generating, by a controller, a sleep control signal to cause a memory cell to transition from a sleep state to an operational state at a first time. In some embodiments, the method includes detecting, by the controller, the memory cell has transitioned from the sleep state to the operational state at a second time after the first time. In some embodiments, the method includes causing, by the controller, an output driver coupled to the memory cell to maintain an output signal to have a predetermined voltage irrespective of data stored by the memory cell, until the second time. In some embodiments, the method includes causing, by the controller, the output driver to generate the output signal indicating the data stored by the memory cell after the second time.

[0094] The term “coupled” and variations thereof includes the joining of two members directly or indirectly to one another. The term “electrically coupled” and variations thereof includes the joining of two members directly or indirectly to one another through conductive materials (e.g., metal or copper traces). Such joining may be stationary (e.g., permanent or fixed) or moveable (e.g., removable or releasable). Such joining may be achieved with the two members coupled directly with or to each other, with the two members coupled with each other using a separate intervening member and any additional intermediate members coupled with one another, or with the two members coupled with each other using an intervening member that is integrally formed as a single unitary body with one of the two members. If “coupled” or variations thereof are modified by an additional term (e.g., directly coupled), the generic definition of “coupled” provided above is modified by the plain language meaning of the additional term (e.g., “directly coupled” means the joining of two members without any separate intervening member), resulting in a narrower definition than the generic definition of “coupled” provided above. Such coupling may be mechanical, electrical, or fluidic.

[0095] The foregoing outlines features of several embodiments so that those skilled in the art may better understand the aspects of the present disclosure. Those skilled in the art should appreciate that they may readily use the present disclosure as a basis for designing or modifying other processes and structures for carrying out the same purposes and/or achieving the same advantages of the embodiments introduced herein. Those skilled in the art should also realize that such equivalent constructions do not depart from the spirit and scope of the present disclosure, and that they may make various changes, substitutions, and alterations herein without departing from the spirit and scope of the present disclosure.

Claims

- 1.** A memory device comprising: a first output driver coupled to a first memory cell; a second output driver coupled to a second memory cell; and wherein the first output driver is configured to generate a first output signal having a predetermined voltage, in response to a sleep tracking signal indicating that the first memory cell is in a sleep state, and the second output driver is configured to generate a second output signal having the predetermined voltage, in response to the sleep tracking signal indicating that the second memory cell is in the sleep state.
- 2.** The memory device of claim 1, wherein the sleep tracking signal is delayed from a sleep control signal.
- 3.** The memory device of claim 2, further comprising: a sleep control circuit configured to generate the sleep control signal causing at least one of the first or second memory cell to transition from the sleep state to an operational state at a first time; wherein the sleep tracking signal indicates that the at least one of the first or second memory cell has transitioned from the sleep state to the operational state at a second time after the first time.
- 4.** The memory device of claim 3, wherein the first and second output drivers are respectively configured to maintain the first output signal and the second output signal at the predetermined voltage, until the sleep tracking signal indicates that the first or second memory cell has transitioned from the sleep state to the operational state at the second time.
- 5.** The memory device of claim 4, further comprising: a first delay circuit coupled to the first output driver and configured to delay the sleep tracking signal; and a second delay circuit coupled to the second output driver and configured to delay the sleep tracking signal.
- 6.** The memory device of claim 5, further comprising: a first wake-up detection circuit coupled to the first delay circuit, wherein the first wake up detection circuit is configured to generate a first wake up complete signal indicating whether a transition from the sleep state to the operational state by the first memory cell is complete, based on the delayed sleep tracking signal.
- 7.** The memory device of claim 6, further comprising: a second wake-up detection circuit coupled to the second delay circuit, wherein the second wake up detection circuit is configured to generate a second wake up complete signal indicating whether a transition from the sleep state to the operational state by the second memory cell is complete, based on the delayed sleep tracking signal.
- 8.** The memory device of claim 5, wherein each of the first and second delay circuits includes one or more buffer circuits.
- 9.** The memory device of claim 2, wherein each of the first and second output drivers includes: a power switch to provide a supply voltage to one or more circuits in the corresponding first or second output driver, according to the sleep control signal.
- 10.** A memory device comprising: a first memory cell; a second memory cell; a first output driver coupled to the first memory cell, and configured to generate a first output signal having a predetermined voltage, in response to a sleep tracking signal indicating that the first memory cell is in a sleep state; and a second output driver coupled to the second memory cell, and configured to generate a second output signal having the predetermined voltage, in response to the sleep tracking signal indicating that the second memory cell is in the sleep state; wherein the sleep tracking signal is delayed from a sleep control signal.
- 11.** The memory device of claim 10, further comprising: a sleep control circuit configured to generate the sleep control signal causing at least one of the first or second memory cell to transition from the sleep state to an operational state at a first time; wherein the sleep tracking signal indicates that the at least one of the first or second memory cell has transitioned from the sleep state to the operational state at a second time after the first time.
- 12.** The memory device of claim 11, wherein the first and second output drivers are respectively configured to maintain the first output signal and the second output signal at the predetermined voltage, until the sleep tracking signal indicates that the first or second memory cell has

transitioned from the sleep state to the operational state at the second time.

13. The memory device of claim 12, further comprising: a first delay circuit coupled to the first output driver and configured to delay the sleep tracking signal; and a second delay circuit coupled to the second output driver and configured to delay the sleep tracking signal.

14. The memory device of claim 13, further comprising: a first wake-up detection circuit coupled to the first delay circuit, wherein the first wake up detection circuit is configured to generate a first wake up complete signal indicating whether a transition from the sleep state to the operational state by the first memory cell is complete, based on the delayed sleep tracking signal.

15. The memory device of claim 14, further comprising: a second wake-up detection circuit coupled to the second delay circuit, wherein the second wake up detection circuit is configured to generate a second wake up complete signal indicating whether a transition from the sleep state to the operational state by the second memory cell is complete, based on the delayed sleep tracking signal.

16. The memory device of claim 13, wherein each of the first and second delay circuits includes one or more buffer circuits.

17. The memory device of claim 10, wherein each of the first and second output drivers includes: a power switch to provide a supply voltage to one or more circuits in the corresponding first or second output driver, according to the sleep control signal.

18. A memory device comprising: a first memory cell; a second memory cell; a first output driver coupled to the first memory cell, and configured to generate a first output signal having a predetermined voltage, in response to a sleep tracking signal indicating that the first memory cell is in a sleep state; a second output driver coupled to the second memory cell, and configured to generate a second output signal having the predetermined voltage, in response to the sleep tracking signal indicating that the second memory cell is in the sleep state; and a sleep control circuit configured to generate a sleep control signal causing at least one of the first or second memory cell to transition from the sleep state to an operational state at a first time, wherein the sleep tracking signal indicates that the at least one of the first or second memory cell has transitioned from the sleep state to the operational state at a second time after the first time; wherein the sleep tracking signal is delayed from the sleep control signal.

19. The memory device of claim 18, further comprising: a first delay circuit coupled to the first output driver and configured to delay the sleep tracking signal; and a second delay circuit coupled to the second output driver and configured to delay the sleep tracking signal.

20. The memory device of claim 19, wherein each of the first and second delay circuits includes one or more buffer circuits.
